

Teen Convicted Under Internet Piracy Law

Parvin Dhalwal, 18, is the first person in the US to be convicted, under state laws, for illegally downloading music and movies off the Net. He was sentenced to a three-month deferred jail sentence, three years of probation, 200 hours of community service, and a \$5,400 (approx. Rs 2,35,500) fine.



A Robot In Every Japanese Home

Officials have compiled a report predicting that every household in Japan will own at least one robot by 2015. Robots are already used as receptionists, night watchmen, hospital workers, guides, pets and more. This trend may, scientists say, change lifestyles more radically than computers did.



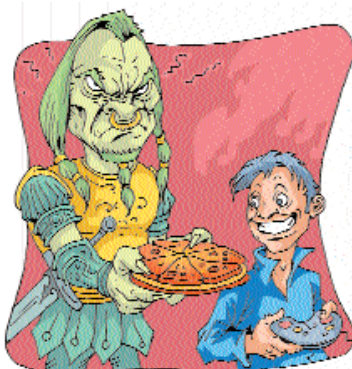
Escape

KEEP GAMING

Virtual Pizza—For Real

How'd you like to order a pizza by visiting a pizza store in a game? Sony has recently made it possible to do just that: one can now order pizza while playing the online multiplayer game *Everquest II*. The idea is to not leave the game while you are ordering the pizza; one simply needs to type in '/pizza' within the game. This leads one to the online ordering section of Pizza Hut to place an order. Soon, players will be able to pay for such orders via their monthly gaming bill.

Although it's not a big deal quitting the game and ordering a pizza the regular way, it is certainly a novelty to be able to order within the game itself. The concept adds to the virtual gaming experience—and it could



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

certainly mean more pizza orders, what with the number of *Everquest* subscribers. Schemes such as free games, as long as one spends more than, say, \$30 a month on purchases, seem almost sure to come.

Sony Online Entertainment said that it thinks this is the first time a game has been able to accept orders for real-world items. It certainly won't be the last.

CELL USE WHILE DRIVING UP

Driving Under The Influence

In an earlier issue of *Digit*, we reported that people talking on cell phones, while driving have their mental age reduced to approximately that of a 10-year old, in terms of response times. And now, as per a survey released by the United States National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, more people than ever are using their cell phones while driving. The survey was conducted at 1,200 road sites across the country and, in some cases, supplemented by telephone surveys. It showed that 8 per cent of the drivers were using hand-held or hands-free cell phones during daylight hours last year, a 50 per cent increase since

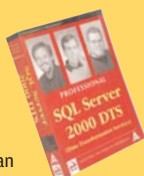
Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? Send it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

The winner receives a copy of professional **SQL Server 2000 DTS**

By Mark Chaffin, Brian Knight and Todd Robinson, published by Shroff Publishers & Distributors P. Ltd. This month's winner is Rajneesh Raghu, Fareedabad



Rajneesh's desktop has an Apple-style dock. Sent in by Rajneesh Raghu, Fareedabad

UNUSABLE!

www.nellikkal.com



This site, called 'Nellikkal Computers', is the Web site of a computer company based in Nagercoil, Tamil Nadu. For some strange reason, the site's builders seem to think that tantalising you with pictures and terms is better than actually offering clickable products. For instance, clicking 'Networking' leads you to a page that helpfully lists a few networking terms. 'Laptop' takes you to a page where there are, umm, pictures of a few laptops. No prices, though—and nothing like "available here" or anything. Ostensibly, we are to assume that these laptops are available at the store.

Clicking 'Computers' takes you to a page where three computer configurations are given. It's not even clear whether these configurations are available at Nellikkal Computers. But at least that's better than just pictures, isn't it?

An 'under construction' sign would have helped us make some sense of this, but there's none.

The rest of the links don't work—and they don't give errors, to the site's credit: they are conveniently not clickable.

The only link that's of any use is 'Contact us'—but we wonder who'd want to contact them after a look at the site!